

01 SMALL TALK

When you buy a gift for a friend, do you check the price first, or pick what they'd like first?

When was the last time you went to a wedding?

Do you have a few close friends, or many friends you meet sometimes?

02 POP QUIZ — DOES THIS SOUND NATURAL?

① ~~"I cannot contact to her."~~

✓ "I can't reach her. / I can't get in touch with her."

contact는 바로 목적어가 오는 타동사라 to가 필요 없어요. 보통 reach나 get in touch with를 더 자주 써요.

② ~~"We are very close friend."~~

✓ "We're very close friends. / We're really close."

두 사람 이상이니 friends 복수가 맞아요. We're really close.처럼 형용사만 써도 자연스러워요.

③ ~~"We promised to meet next week."~~

✓ "We made plans to meet next week. / We're meeting next week."

promised to는 굳은 맹세처럼 들려서 과해요. 가벼운 약속은 made plans나 현재진행형으로 말해요.

03 오늘의 워업

앞은 자리에서 한 명씩 돌아가며 A 또는 B를 빠르게 고르고, 한 단어로 이유를 말해요. 5라운드를 꼭 진행해요.

WARM-UP

This or That · 빠른 5라운드

1

Saver vs Spender

2

Treat my friends vs Split the bill

3

Stay in vs Go out

4

Plan ahead vs Decide last minute

5

Cash gift vs Pick the gift myself

FRIENDSHIP · MAIN DISCUSSION

Friend Wedding Gift Money — Closeness or Budget First?

🇰🇷 BACKGROUND

친구 결혼식 축의금은 단순히 돈을 얼마 낼지의 문제가 아니라, 친밀도와 내 통장 사정이 부딪히는 순간이에요. 마음은 크게 하고 싶어도 같은 달에 결혼식이 여러 번 있거나 월세와 생활비가 빠듯하면 현실적인 기준을 세울 수밖에 없어요. 어려운 점은 축의금이 숫자이면서 동시에 관계의 신호처럼 읽힌다는 거예요. 자주 만나는 친구, 오래된 친구, 직장 동료, 단톡방 친구에게 같은 기준을 적용하기 어렵고, 참석 여부나 식사 여부도 고민에 들어가요. 결국 핵심은 성의와 부담 사이에서 내가 납득할 수 있는 선을 정하는 일이에요.

📖 READ BEFORE WE TALK

Wedding gift money for a friend is not only a budget question. It can feel like a signal of closeness, respect, and good manners. People may want to be generous, but rent, salary, other weddings, and monthly expenses can make the choice much less simple. The tricky part is that the amount is 'visible' in people's minds, even when nobody says it out loud. A close friend, an old friend you rarely meet, a coworker, and a group-chat friend may not feel the same. Attendance, the meal, travel time, and whether that friend once helped you can all change your standard. In Korea, the amount can feel less like a simple gift and more like a sign of respect. That is why people often give differently to a best friend, a coworker, a distant classmate, or a wedding they cannot attend.

💡 WORDS YOU MIGHT NEED

check my budget first — 예산부터 확인하다

follow my heart — 마음 가는 대로 하다

go over my budget — 예산을 넘기다

a fair-weather friend — 좋을 때만 친구

we go way back — 우리 오래된 사이다

come across as cheap — 찼돌이처럼 보이다

🗣️ TRY THESE PHRASES

I'd say closeness matters more, because ____.

It really comes down to how I feel about the person, so ____.

In my case, my standard does change — ____.

Honestly, it depends on the friend, but usually ____.

⚡ EASY ENTRY

- 1 Are you more of a 'cash in a clean envelope' or a 'quick bank transfer' person when it comes to wedding gift money?
- 2 When was the last time you gave wedding gift money? Whose wedding was it?
- 3 Quick — if you had to name your go-to wedding gift amount without overthinking: 50,000 won, 100,000 won, or 'it depends'?
- 4 On a scale of 1 to 5, how much does eating the wedding meal make you feel you should put a bit more in the envelope?

🗣️ MAIN DISCUSSION

Q1. Should wedding gift money depend more on closeness or on your own budget?

↳ *I'd say closeness matters more, because ____.*

↳ *It really comes down to how I feel about the person, so ____.*

Q2. Would your standard change between a close friend and an old friend you rarely meet?

↳ *In my case, my standard does change — ____.*

↳ *Honestly, it depends on the friend, but usually ____.*

Q3. If you can't attend the wedding, should the amount change?

↳ *The way I see it, the amount can be a little lower if ____.*

↳ *If I can't go, I'd still ____ because ____.*

Q4. When there are several weddings in one month, when does it start to feel heavy?

↳ *Most of the time, it starts to feel heavy when ____.*

↳ *When I think about it, the hard part is ____.*

Q5. Does wedding gift money feel more like care, manners, or social pressure to you?

↳ *I lean more toward seeing it as care, because ____.*

↳ *It's a mix for me — part care and part ____.*